

Post-incident review PIR-2025-001

Data Warehouse: intermittent timeouts

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 10 December 2025, Data Warehouse experienced intermittent timeouts in production (AU Southeast) for about 75 minutes. A partner raised a case with the service desk before any internal signal fired. Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw intermittent timeouts for about 75 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:02 First signal received.
- 09:33 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:59 Likely cause identified.
- 10:06 Mitigation applied.
- 10:58 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.